EXPERIMENT 09

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Dashboard Insights, Conditional Formatting, and Kanban Analytics for the Patient Appointment Scheduling System

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Aim

To explore the AI-assisted and built-in analytics capabilities of Zoho Creator — powered by Zia, Zoho's AI assistant — by reviewing the auto-generated dashboard, conditionally formatted reports, and Kanban-grouped views of the Patient Appointment Scheduling System, and to understand how these features turn raw form data into actionable visual insight without writing custom code.

Objectives

- To review the application dashboard's auto-generated summary tiles and charts (Distribution by Priority Level, Distribution by Created By).
- To study how conditional formatting highlights Priority Level and Status values with colour so patterns are visible at a glance.
- To study Kanban report views (Priority Levels, Departments) as a built-in way to group and visualise records without any scripting.
- To review the All Department Masters and All Appointment Records list reports as the structured data these analytics are built on.
- To understand Zia's role within Zoho Creator in suggesting chart types, generating dashboard layouts, and surfacing patterns in application data.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Patient Appointment Scheduling System application (created on Oct 05, 2026)
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Access/Live mode

Introduction / Theory

Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator ships with analytics components that turn form records into visual summaries without any separate BI tool. A Dashboard page can combine summary tiles, pie and bar charts, and embedded reports in one view; individual reports can use conditional formatting to colour rows or cells by field value; and a Kanban report groups records into columns by a chosen field, giving a board-style view of status or priority. All of these read live data directly from the application's forms, so the visuals update automatically as records are added or changed.

Zia — Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, including Creator. Within Creator, Zia-driven features assist application builders by suggesting appropriate chart types for a given report, helping auto-generate dashboard layouts from existing forms, and surfacing trends (such as which priority level or status occurs most often) that would otherwise need manual analysis. Rather than requiring the developer to hand-code every chart, Zia-assisted suggestions speed up the process of turning a plain data table into a meaningful visual summary.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page combining summary tiles, charts, and embedded reports into a single, auto-refreshing overview of application data.
Chart Widget	A visual element (pie, bar, donut, etc.) bound to a report that summarises records by a chosen field, such as Priority Level or Created By.
Conditional Formatting	A report-level rule that colours a cell or row automatically based on its value, making outliers (e.g. Urgent priority, Cancelled status) stand out without manual review.
Kanban Report	A board-style report that groups records into columns by a selected field (e.g. Priority Level, Department), letting staff drag and scan records visually.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions within Zoho Creator that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts, and highlight patterns in the underlying data.

Application Specifications

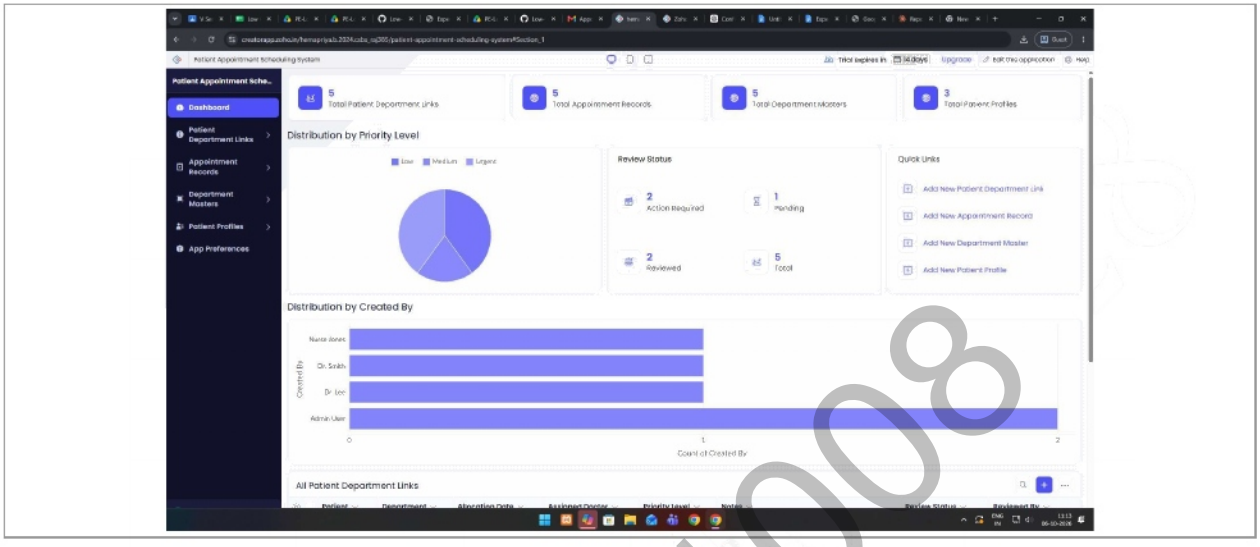
Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Patient Appointment Scheduling System
Primary Forms	Patient Profile, Appointment Record, Department Master, Patient Department Link
Dashboard Elements	Total Patient Department Links, Total Appointment Records, Total Department Masters, Total Patient Profiles tiles; Distribution by Priority Level pie chart; Review Status tiles; Distribution by Created By bar chart
Conditionally Formatted Reports	All Patient Department Links (coloured by Priority Level), All Appointment Records (coloured by Status)
Kanban Reports	Priority Levels (grouped by Priority Level: High, Urgent, Low, Medium), Departments (grouped by Department under Patient Profiles)
Master Data Report	All Department Masters — Department Name, Code, Head of Department, Contact Email/Phone, Location, Is Active, Description

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Procedure

1. Open the application dashboard — Opening the Patient Appointment Scheduling System loads its Dashboard, which auto-summarises the four forms into tiles and charts as soon as records exist.

Figure 9.1: Dashboard — Auto-Generated Summary Tiles and Charts



The dashboard shows four live count tiles (5 Patient Department Links, 5 Appointment Records, 5 Department Masters, 3 Patient Profiles), a Distribution by Priority Level pie chart, Review Status counts, Quick Links shortcuts, and a Distribution by Created By bar chart — all generated directly from form data with no manual charting.

2. Inspect the conditionally formatted department-link report — The All Patient Department Links report was opened to see how its Priority Level column is colour-coded automatically.

Figure 9.2: All Patient Department Links — Conditional Formatting by Priority Level

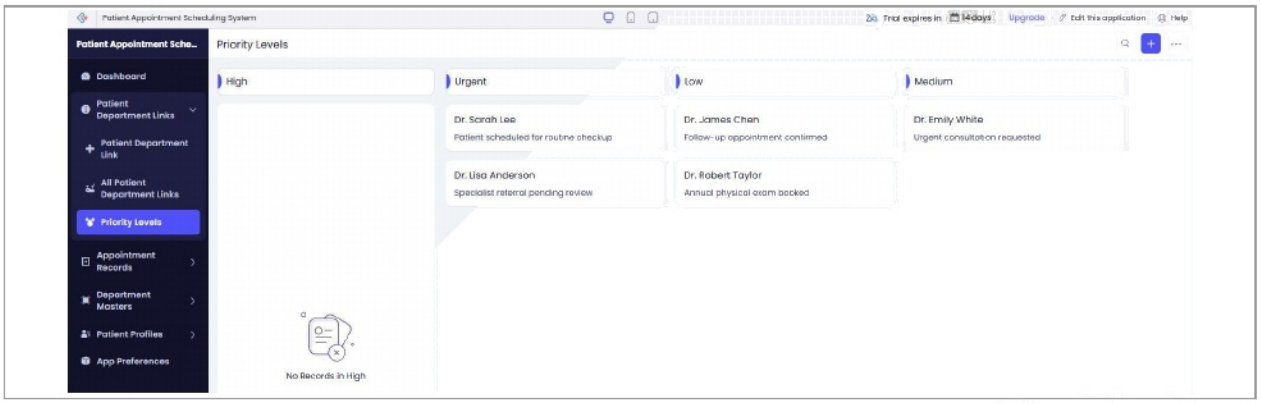


Each row's Priority Level cell is shaded by value — red for Urgent, purple for Low, green for Medium — so a reviewer can scan the whole report and spot urgent cases immediately rather than reading every row.

3. Switch to the Priority Levels Kanban view — A Kanban report named Priority Levels was opened, grouping the same department-link records into columns by their Priority Level field.

Figure 9.3: Priority Levels — Kanban Report

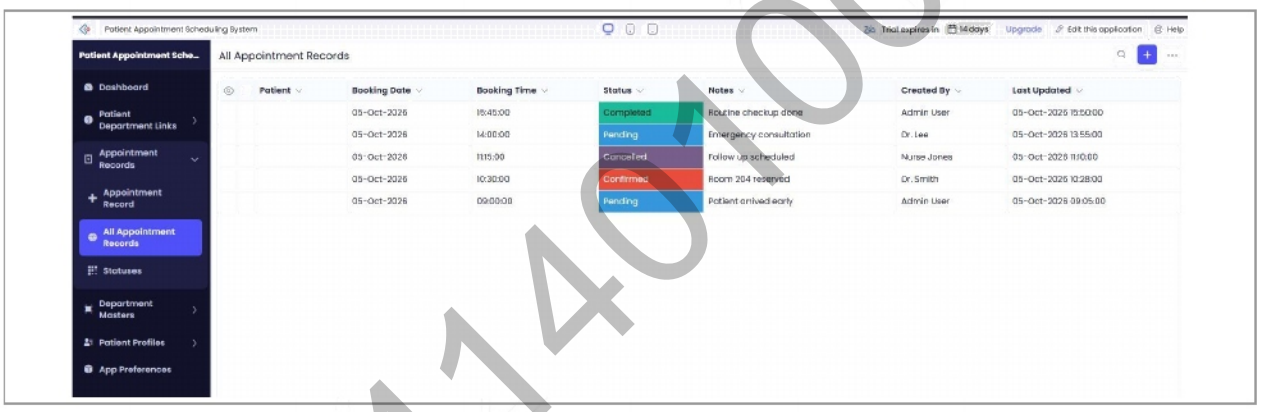
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The board shows four columns (High, Urgent, Low, Medium) with each record rendered as a card under the doctor's name and note; High currently has no records, which the report states explicitly instead of leaving the column ambiguous.

4. Review the appointment-status report — The All Appointment Records report was opened next, where the Status column uses the same conditional-colouring approach.

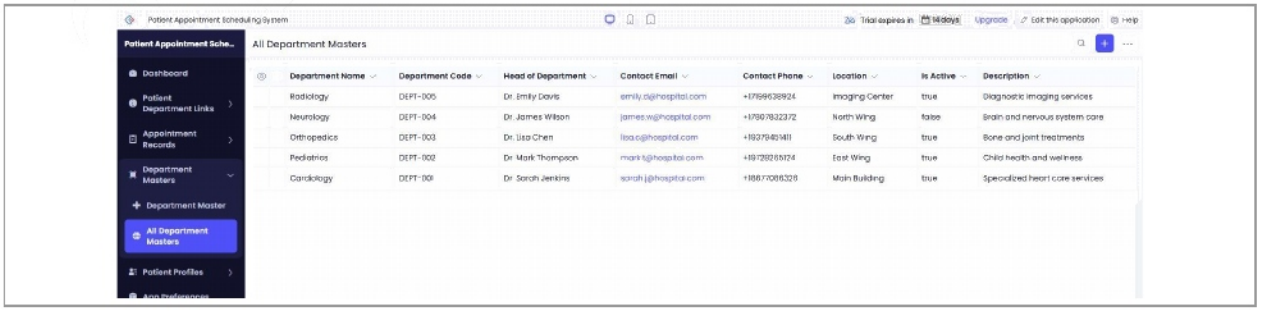
Figure 9.4: All Appointment Records — Conditional Formatting by Status



Status values are colour-coded (green for Completed, blue for Pending, purple for Cancelled, red for Confirmed), letting front-desk staff see at a glance which bookings still need action.

5. Review the underlying master data — The All Department Masters report was opened to confirm the structured reference data (department codes, heads, contacts) that other analytics and lookups draw on.

Figure 9.5: All Department Masters — Structured Reference Data

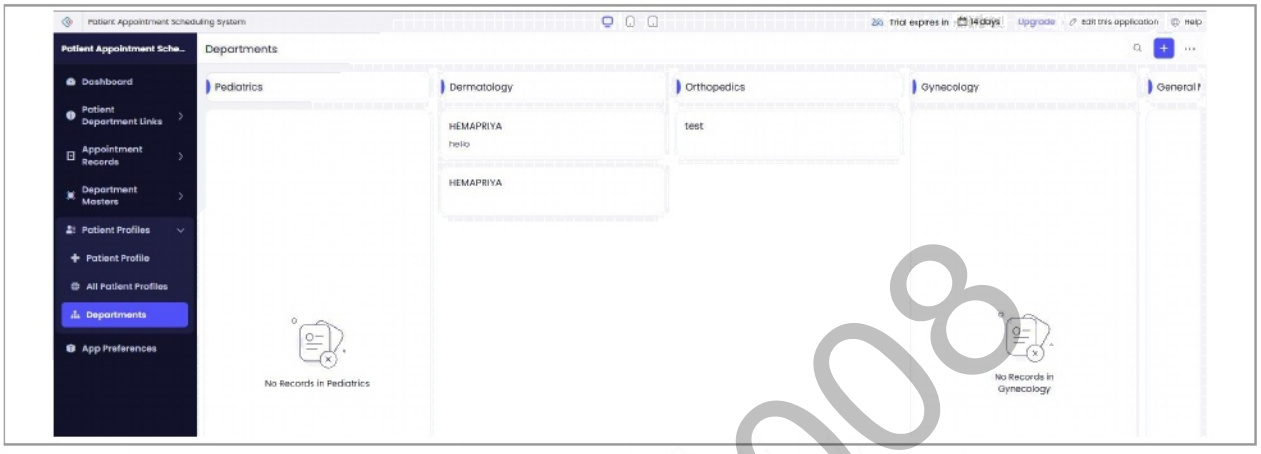


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Five departments (Radiology, Neurology, Orthopedics, Pediatrics, Cardiology) are listed with their code, head, contact details, location and active status, forming the clean reference data that the dashboard and Kanban views ultimately summarise.

6. Explore the Departments Kanban view — Finally, a second Kanban report, Departments, was opened under Patient Profiles to see patient records grouped visually by department.

Figure 9.6: Departments — Kanban Report Grouped by Department



Patient profile cards are grouped into columns such as Pediatrics, Dermatology, Orthopedics, and Gynecology; empty columns (Pediatrics, Gynecology) are labelled "No Records" rather than left blank, keeping the board readable even with sparse data.

Result

- The Patient Appointment Scheduling System's auto-generated Dashboard was reviewed, confirming it summarises all four forms into live tiles and charts without manual configuration.
- Conditional formatting was observed on two reports — All Patient Department Links (by Priority Level) and All Appointment Records (by Status) — both colouring values automatically to highlight patterns.
- Two Kanban report views, Priority Levels and Departments, were reviewed, confirming records can be grouped and browsed visually by any chosen field.
- The All Department Masters report was reviewed as the structured reference data underlying these analytics.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator's built-in analytics and Zia-assisted features convert plain form records into decision-ready visuals with no custom charting code. The dashboard's tiles and charts give an instant overview of volume and distribution, conditional formatting turns a flat table into a scannable priority or status map, and Kanban reports let staff browse the same data as a visual board grouped by whatever field matters most — priority, status, or department. Together these features show that low-code analytics in Zoho Creator is not an afterthought bolted onto the application, but a natural extension of the same structured forms and reports already built in earlier experiments.

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